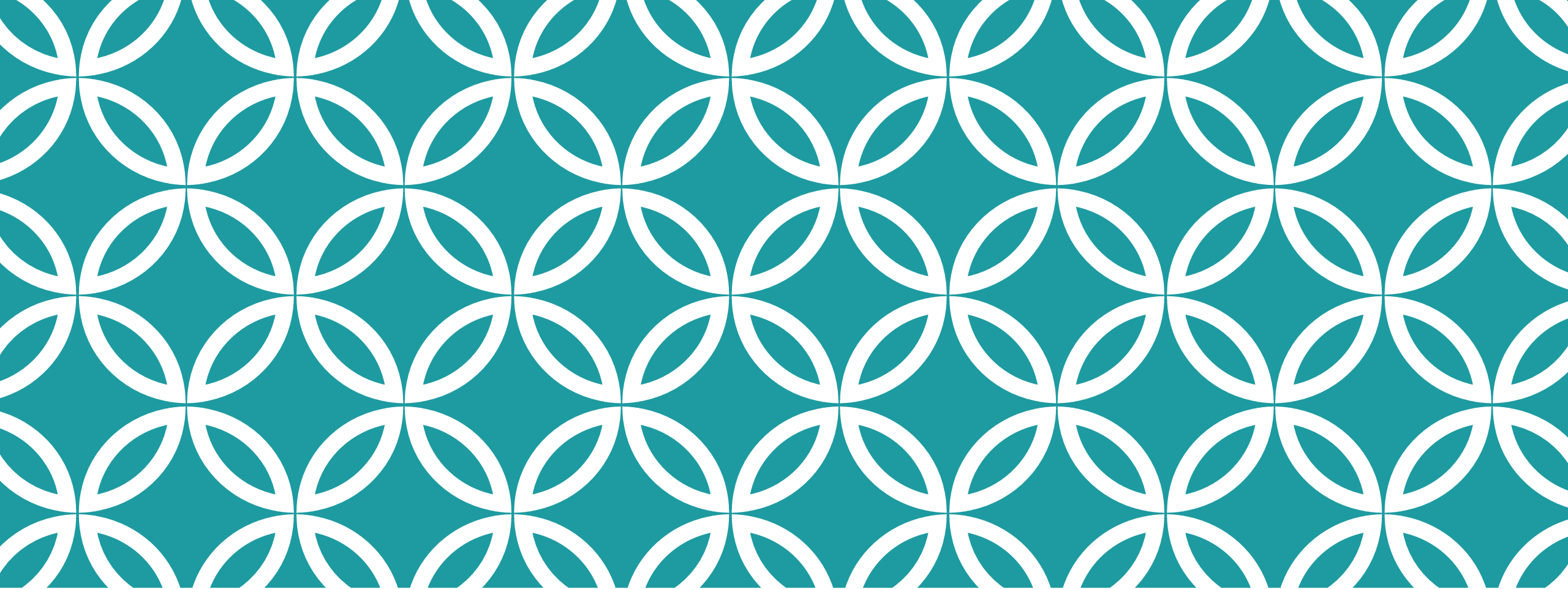
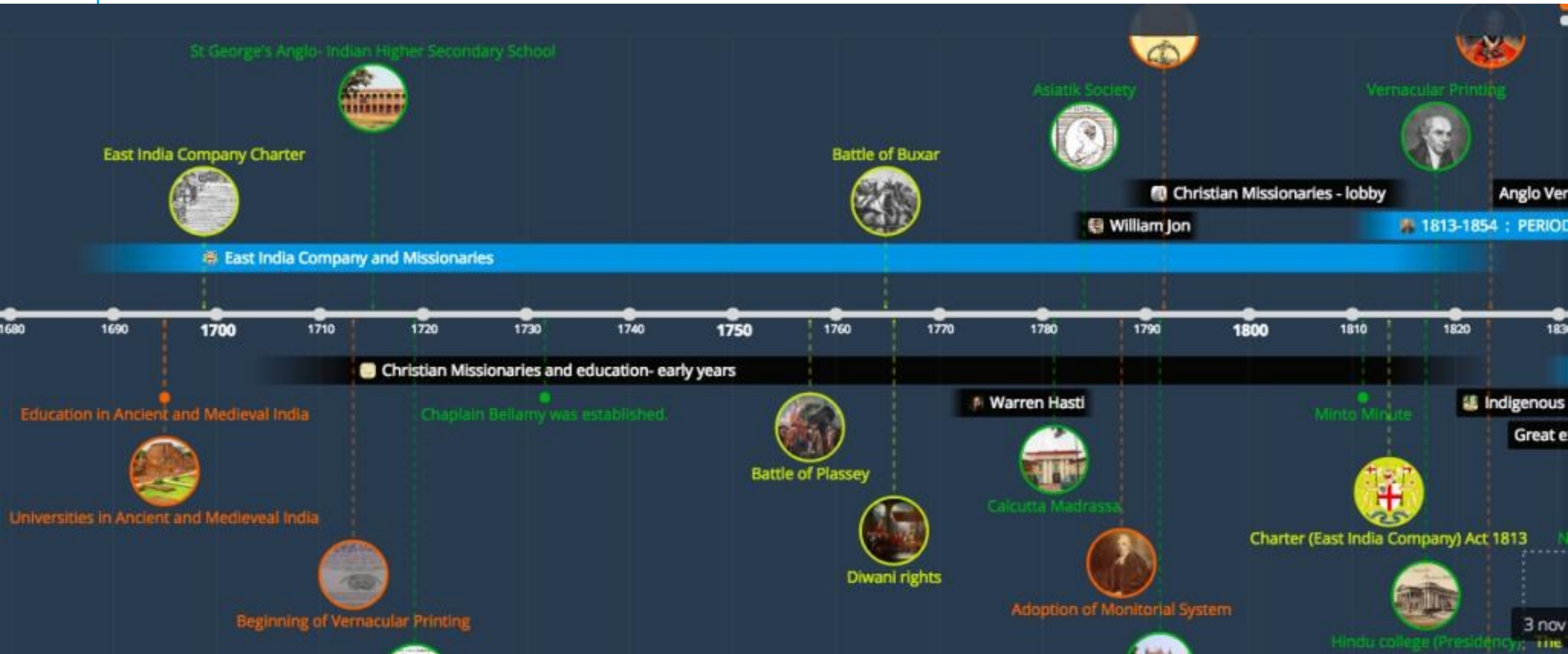




IMPACT OF BRITISH EDUCATION ON INDIAN SOCIETY

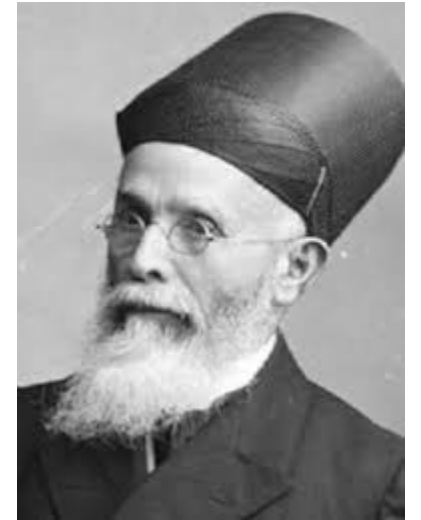
TIMELINE OF EDUCATION IN COLONIAL INDIA



TIMELINE- <https://time.graphics/line/2337>

EFFECTS OF THE WESTERN EDUCATION IN BRITISH INDIA

Impact on Literature, Society, Religion, and Politics



<https://time.graphics/line/2337>

GROWTH OF LITERATURE AND PRESS

Missionaries' Role: Started the first printing press and newspapers.

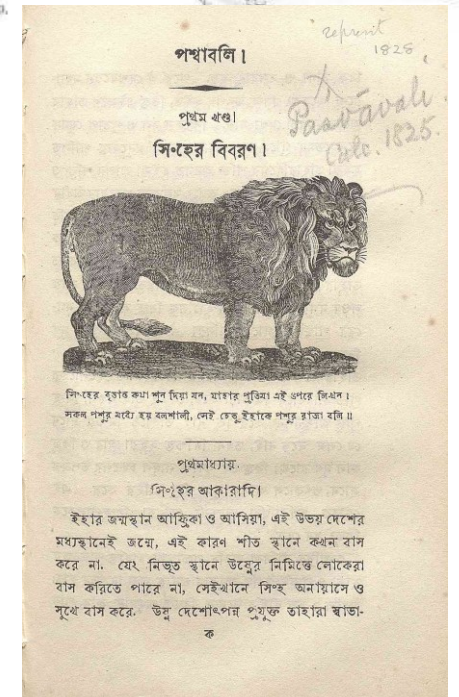
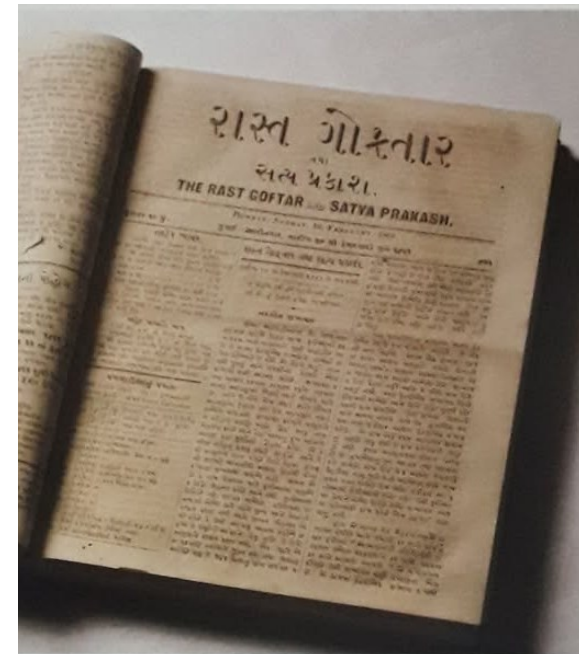
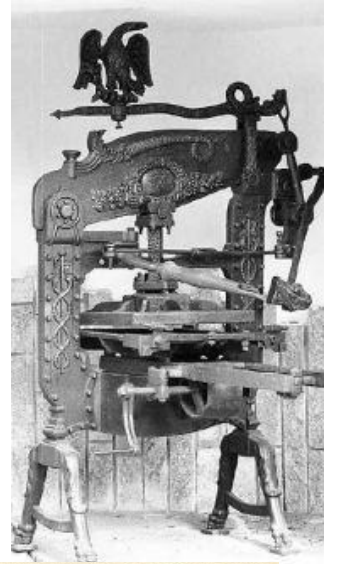
Company & Government's Role: Publishing of books in Indian languages.

Private Enterprise: Educated Indians formed societies to publish books and newspapers.

Development of modern Indian literature and a growing press.



WILLIAM CAREY, D.D.

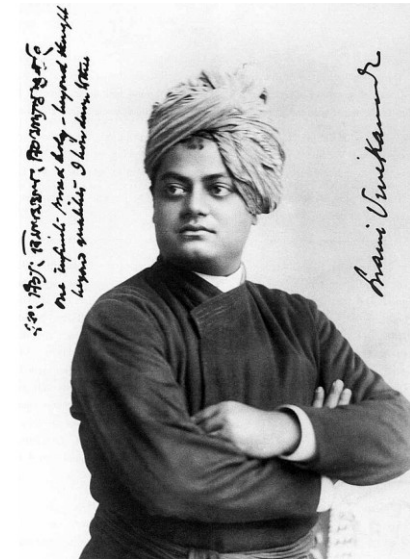
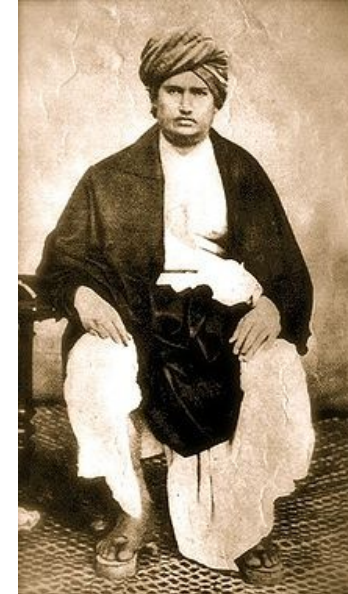


SOCIAL AND RELIGIOUS REFORMS

Strengthened movements for caste reform, widow remarriage, and the abolition of untouchability.

Key Reform Movements: **Brahmo Samaj** (Raja Ram Mohan Roy), **Arya Samaj** (Swami Dayanand Saraswati) **Ramakrishna Mission** (Swami Vivekananda)

Step towards modernization of Hindu society and rejection of orthodox traditions.





Lord Canning
1858-63



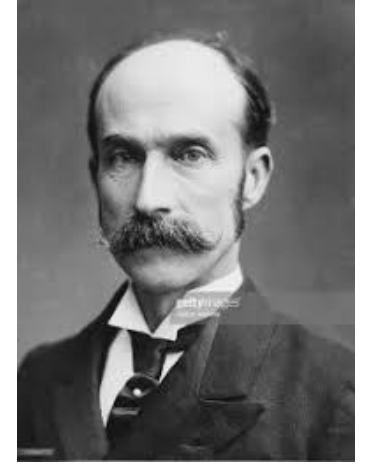
Lord Mayo
1869-72



Lord Lytton
1876-1880



Lord Ripon
1880-1884



Lord Lansdowne
1888-1894

Viceroy of India In Victorian Period



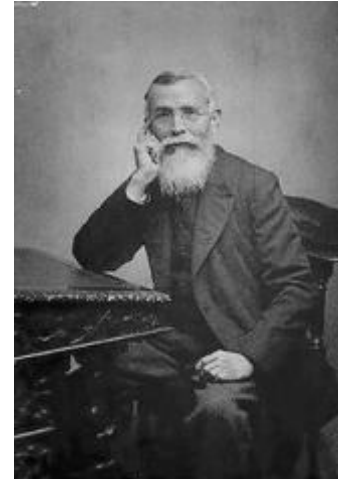
Jyotirao Phule



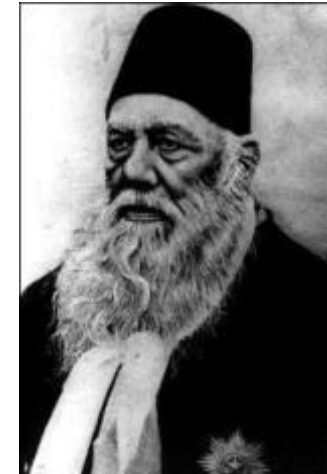
Savitribai Phule



Tarabhai Shinde



Dadabhai Naoroji



**Sayyid Ahmed
Khan**



**Ishwar Chandra
Vidyasagar**

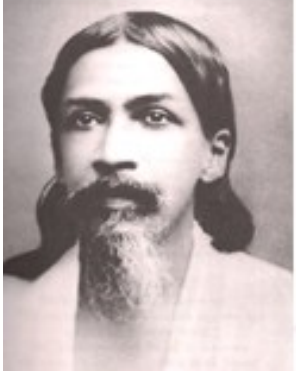
MAKERS OF MODERN INDIA IN VICTORIAN PERIOD

IMPACT ON POLITICAL AWAKENING

Early Focus on Social Reforms: Educated Indians, mostly government servants, engaged in social reform rather than politics.

Shift to Political Awareness: Growing discontent with British policies. Awareness of economic exploitation and lack of political rights.

Birth of Political Consciousness: Led to the formation of the **Indian National Congress (1885)**.



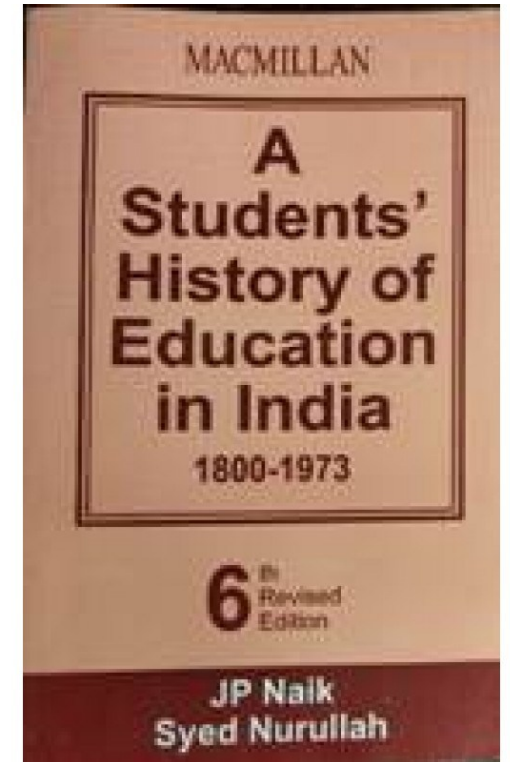
Bhikaji Rustom
Cama

ROLE OF WESTERN THOUGHT IN NATIONALISM

- **Influence of English History:** Inspired ideas of democracy and self-rule.
- **Educated Class's Perspective:**
 - Recognized Britain's contributions but also saw its exploitative nature.
 - Advocated for self-rule rather than just good governance.
- **Education as a Tool for Resistance:** Helped organize movements against colonial rule.

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CHANGING WESTERN ATTITUDES TOWARDS INDIAN KNOWLEDGE

- **Early Views (Pre-1854):** British saw Indian philosophy and literature as inferior.
- **Post-1854 Shift:**
 - Translations of Indian texts (Upanishads, Vedas).
 - European scholars like Max Müller popularized Sanskrit literature.
 - Indian universities promoted the study of classical languages.
- **Result:** Greater appreciation and synthesis of Eastern and Western knowledge.

CULTURAL SYNTHESIS & IDENTITY CRISIS

- **Early Effects:** Imitation of Western manners, clothing, and even food habits.
- **Shift to Cultural Synthesis:**
 - **Emergence of a National Identity:** Led by figures like Vidyasagar, Naoroji, Vivekananda.
 - **New Outlook:** Acceptance of useful Western ideas while preserving Indian traditions.
- **Result:** A more balanced, modernized Indian intellectual class.

EDUCATION IN INDIA DURING THE BRITISH PERIOD

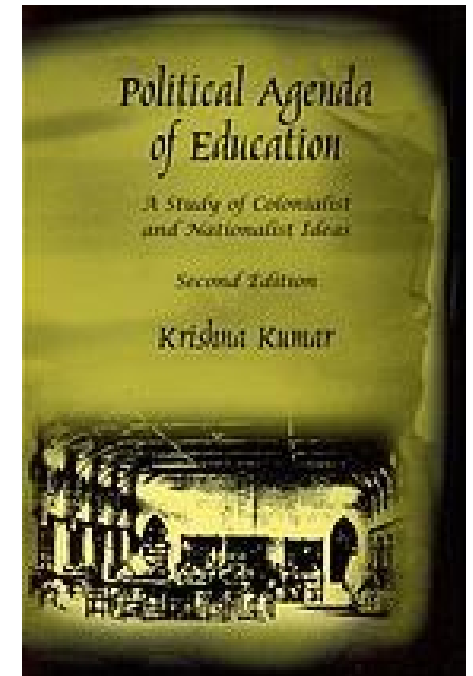
Achievements, Failures, and Legacy

HOW DID BRITISH RULE SHAPE INDIAN EDUCATION?

Two Contrasting Views:

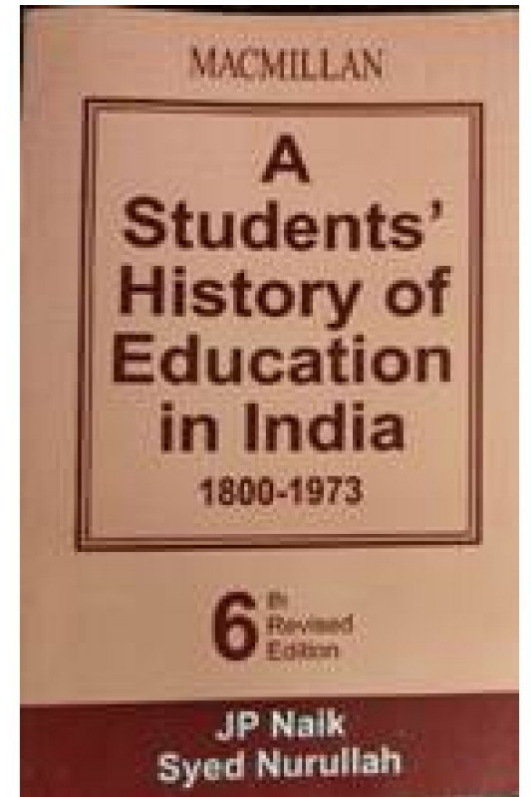
- British claimed they modernized education.
- Indians argued it was politically motivated and inadequate.

Need a balanced, critical evaluation.



CONTRIBUTIONS OF BRITISH EDUCATION POLICIES

- **Despite its failures, British education brought:**
Introduction of English literature & science to India.
- **Scientific study of Indian culture** (e.g., Sanskrit, historical texts).
- **Development of modern Indian languages** (missionary work, dictionaries).
- **Preservation of art & heritage** (Curzon's conservation efforts).



BRITISH VIEW OF INDIA'S ROLE

- **Colonial Perspective on India:**

- Seen as a **market for British goods**, not as a developing nation.
- Missionaries saw India as a **conversion ground**.

British industries benefited, **but Indian development was ignored.**

Education policies focused on serving British needs, not Indian aspirations.

BRITISH FAILURE TO CREATE A NATIONAL EDUCATION SYSTEM

British Failure to Create a National Education System

- **Education remained fragmented:**
 - Transferred to Indian control in 1921, but no solid framework existed.
 - The 1944 Post-War Education Plan came too late.

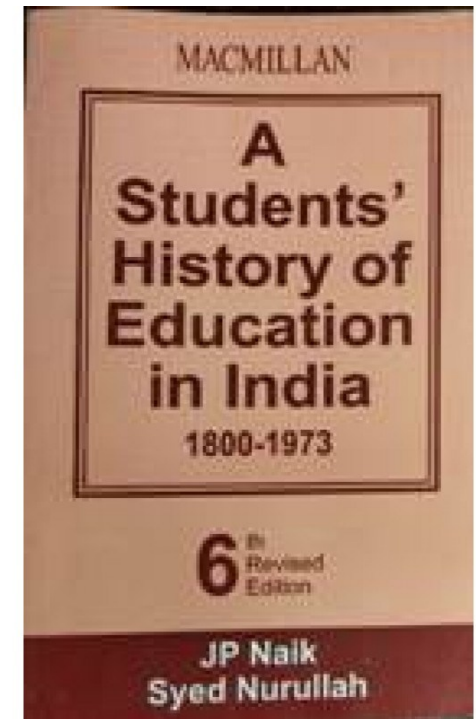
A delayed and inconsistent educational structure.

INFLUENCE ON SOCIAL & POLITICAL REFORMS

- **Western education led to: Rise of social movements** (abolition of untouchability, women's rights).
- **Political awareness → Seeds of Indian Nationalism.**
- **Introduction to democratic institutions & modern governance.**
Legacy: Inspired leaders like Gandhi, Nehru, and Ambedkar.

LIMITATIONS OF THE NEW EDUCATION SYSTEM

- **Economic Neglect:** Education did not promote industrial or vocational skills.
- Lack of technical and **Vocational education** (**Gandhi's lament and *Nai Talim***)
- **Limited Reach:** Only a small elite received education.
- **Class & Caste Divide:**
 - Benefited urban, upper-caste elites.
 - Rural and lower-caste masses remained largely uneducated.
 - Gap between those who “**work with mind**” (**white collar, *babu***) and “**work with hand**” (**blue collar**)
- **Enduring Impact:** Social divide in education still persists today.



KEY POLICY MISTAKES & THEIR EFFECTS

Neglect of Indigenous Education: Led to its decline.

English-Centric Model: Ignored regional languages.

Downward Filtration Theory: Kept education restricted to the elite. *Created **social and economic divides** in access to education.*

LACK OF EAST-WEST EDUCATIONAL SYNTHESIS

- **Failure to integrate Western and Indian knowledge.**
- **British officials:** Many dismissed Indian culture as inferior.

Lost opportunity to create a **blended education model.**

LEGACY

- **Transformation in Indian Society:** Education fostered literature, press, social reforms, and nationalism.
- **Seeds of the Independence Movement:** Awareness of colonial exploitation led to organized resistance.
- **Continuing Relevance:** Challenges of access and equity in education persist in India even today.

Education system was a paradox—while it empowered Indians intellectually, it also reinforced social inequalities.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Progress of Illiteracy in India (1931-41)

(The figures are in thousands)

Province or State	In 1931				From 1932 to 1941			
	Total Population	No. of Literates	Per-centage of Literacy	No. of Illiterates on hand	No. of Illiterates added (Increase in Population)	No. of Illiterates reduced (Increase in Literates)	Per-centage of Literacy	Net in-crease in Illiteracy
Bombay	17,992	1,774	9.5	16,218	2,866	2,294	19.5	572
Madras	46,740	4,320	9.3	42,420	2,602	2,101	13.0	501
Bengal	50,114	4,694	9.4	45,420	10,200	5,026	16.1	5,174
Bihar	32,371	1,344	4.2	31,027	3,969	1,996	9.2	1,973
Orissa	5,306	539	10.2	4,767	3,423	409	10.9	3,014
U. P.	48,409	2,260	4.8	46,149	6,312	2,393	8.5	3,919
C. P.	14,667	868	5.9	13,799	2,155	1,042	11.3	1,113
N. W. F.	2,425	100	4.1	2,325	613	134	7.7	479
Punjab	23,581	1,248	5.3	22,333	4,838	2,418	12.9	2,420
Sind	3,887	230	5.9	3,657	650	244	10.5	406
Assam	8,622	666	7.7	7,956	1,583	508	11.5	1,075
Travancore	5,096	1,218	23.9	3,878	974	1,176	47.7	202
Cochin	1,205	339	28.1	866	218	165	35.4	53
Baroda	2,443	435	17.7	2,008	412	222	23.0	190
Gwalior	3,523	141	4.4	3,382	469	156	7.4	313
Hyderabad	14,436	596	4.1	13,840	1,748	515	6.9	1,233
Kashmir	3,646	124	3.4	3,422	375	140	6.5	235
Mysore	6,557	594	9.1	5,963	772	320	12.2	470
All India	3,38,170	23,493	7.0	3,14,677	50,630	23,830	12.2	26,800

Nurullah
and Naik

COMPULSORY EDUCATION ACTS

Table I. Compulsory Education Acts in British India.

Year	Province	Name of Act	Whether for boys or girls	Areas
1919	Punjab	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal
1919	United Provinces	P.E. Act	Both	Municipal
1919	Bengal	P.E. Act	Boys	Municipal
1919	Bihar & Orissa	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal
1920	Bombay	City of Bombay P.E. Act	Both	City of Bombay
1920	Central Provinces	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1920	Madras	Elementary Education Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1923	Bombay	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1926	Assam	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1926	United Provinces	District Boards P.E. Act	Both	Rural
1930	Bengal	Bengal (Rural) P.E. Act	Both	Rural
1932	Bengal	P.E. (Amendment) Act	Girls	Municipal
1939	N.W.F.	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal

Source. Naik (1942b, p. 12), Nurullah and Naik (1970, p. 302).

Note. P.E. = Primary Education; N.W.F. = North West Frontier.

PROGRESS IN COMPULSORY EDUCATION: 1937-45

Compulsory Primary Education, 1947-48

Province	Age-group under compulsion	Area with boys only under compulsion		Area with boys and girls under compulsion	
		No. of towns and cities	No. of villages	No. of towns and cities	No. of villages
Bihar	6-10	17	—	—	—
Bombay	7-8, 6-11	9	134	110	5,100
C.P. and Berar	6-11, 7-12	34	1,031	—	—
East Punjab	6-11	37	1,420	—	—
Madras	6-14, 6-12	16	31	12	1,607
Orissa	6-12, 6-13, 5-10	1	1	—	—
U.P.*	6-11	36	1,371	3	3
West Bengal	6-10	1	—	—	—
Delhi	6-12	1	7	—	—

*Figures relate to 1946-47.

If these statistics are compared with those of 1936-37, it will be noticed that **the best progress was made in Bombay where compulsion was introduced in several municipal areas and in all villages with a population of 1,000 or more.**

In other parts of India, the progress can only be called poor. When it is remembered that the nation was irrevocably committed to the introduction of compulsory education for boys and girls in the age group of 6 to 14 before 1960-61, it becomes at once evident that the **progress of compulsory education in the past, if it can be called progress at all, was extremely disappointing**

STATE OF EDUCATION AT INDIA'S INDEPENDENCE

Population in 1947 : around 406 million (India + Pakistan combined)

Elementary Education:

- **Elementary schools: 1.72 lakhs** (decline from 1.89 lakhs in 1936-37)
- **Number of pupils : 1.3 crore** (increase from 1.05 crore in 1937)
- **Expenditure: 15.5 crores**

Secondary Education:

- **Number of schools: 17,250** (Increase from 13,400 in 1936-37)
- **Number of Pupils: 36.06 lakhs** (Increase from 23.93 lakhs in 1936-37)
- **Expenditure: 17.9 crores**

Higher Education:

- **15 Universities**, 16,000 students , expenditure – 2.03 crores
- **300 Arts and Science Colleges**, Pupils: 96,000 , expenditure- 3.53 crores
- **16 engineering and technical colleges**, 72,000 students; expenditure – 2.73 crores

Schools in Colonial India -1929

Percentage of primary educational Institutions by management and provinces- 1929

Review by Hartog Committee 1929, (includes Male and Female schools)

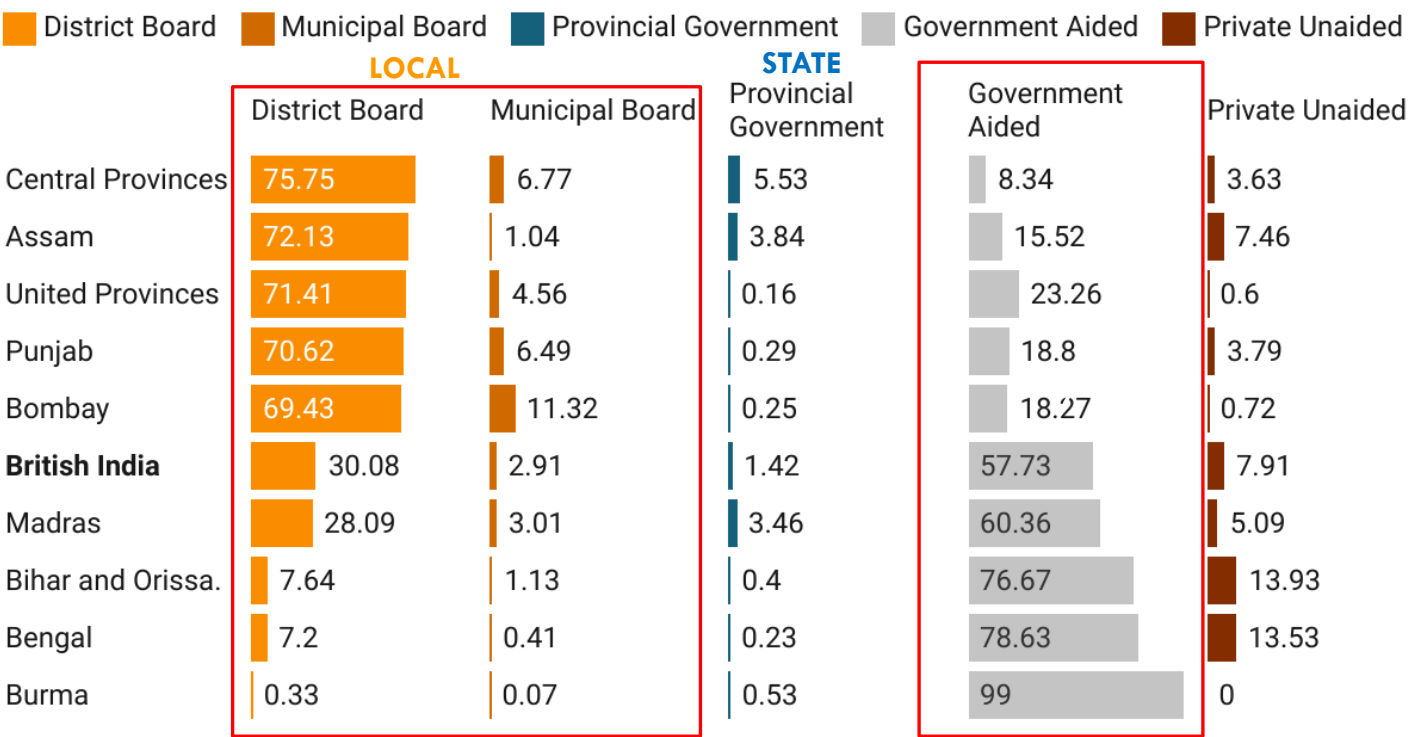


Chart: Shivakumar Jolad • Source: Auxiallry Committee (Education) of the Indian Statutory Commission 1929 • Created with Datawrapper

INTERIM REPORT of the Indian Statutory Commission. (Review of Growth of Education in British India by the Auxiliary Committee appointed by the Commission.) SEPTEMBER, 1929.



Philip Hartog

Percentage of Schools by Management in different States in India

Based on UDISE 2019-20

■ Department of Education
 ■ Local body
 ■ Tribal/Social Welfare Department
 ■ Other govt. schools
 ■ Other central govt. schools
 ■ Government Aided
 ■ Private Unaided (Recog/ Unrecog/ Madrassas)

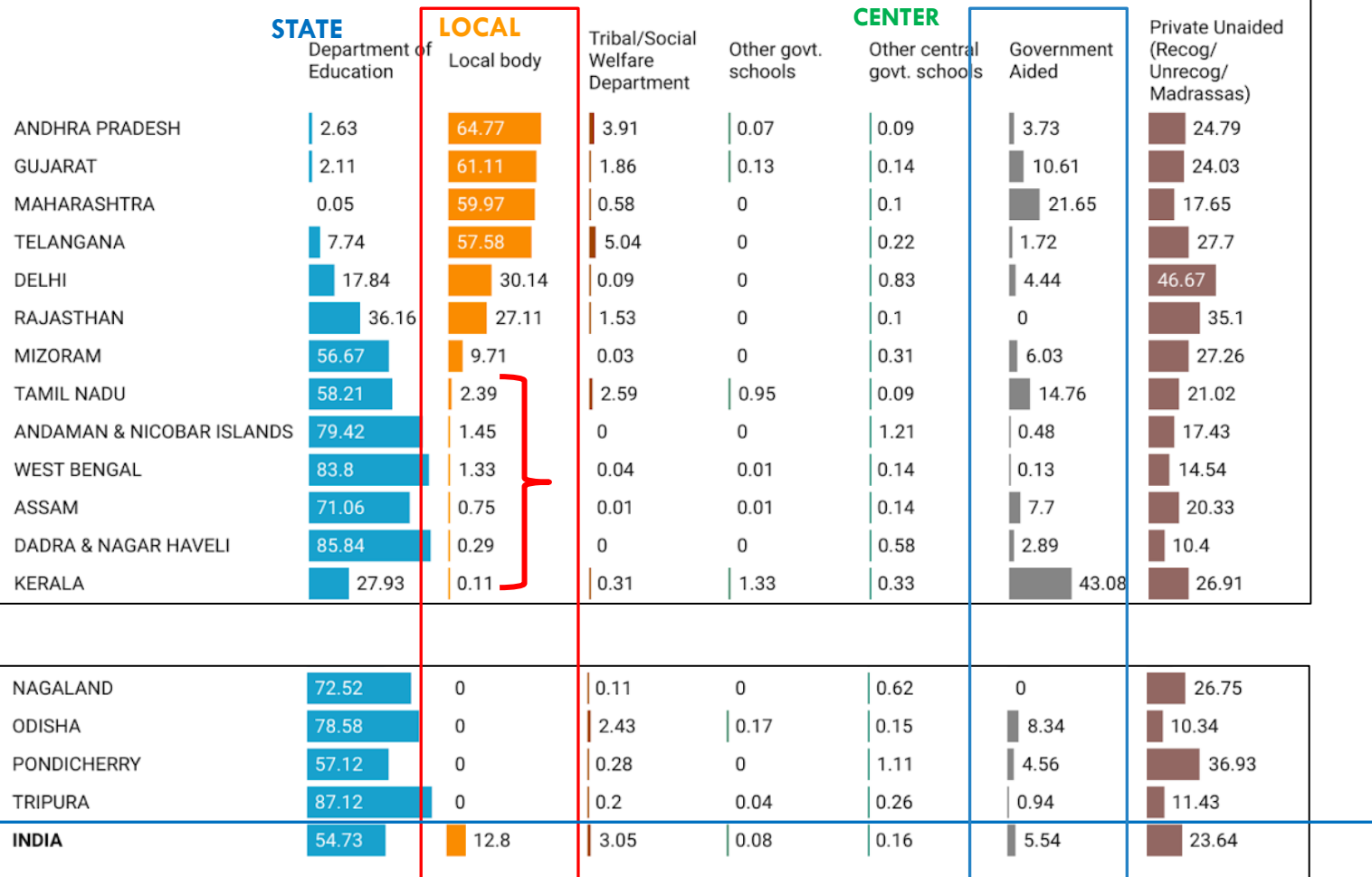
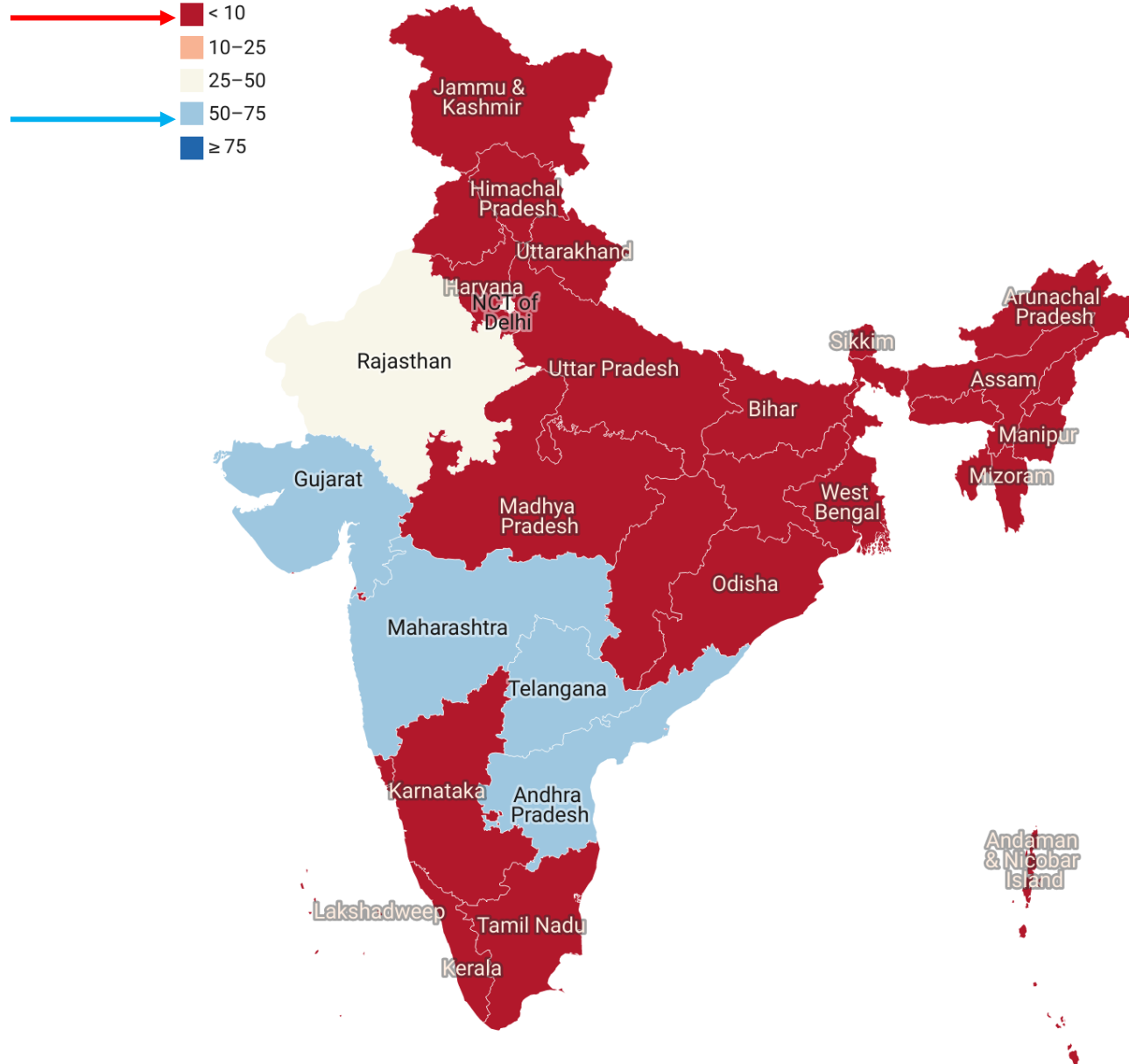


Chart: Khushi Rajpuria and Shivakumar Jolad • Source: UDISE 2019-20 • Created with Datawrapper

Percentage of Local Body Schools in Indian States

Local body schools (%) - based on UDISE 2021-22



State control of school education in colonial and post-colonial India

Shivakumar Jolad 

Department of Social Sciences, FLAME University, Pune, India

Khushi Rajpuria

University of Manchester, Manchester, UK

Alumni, FLAME University, Pune, India

Management in Education

1–14

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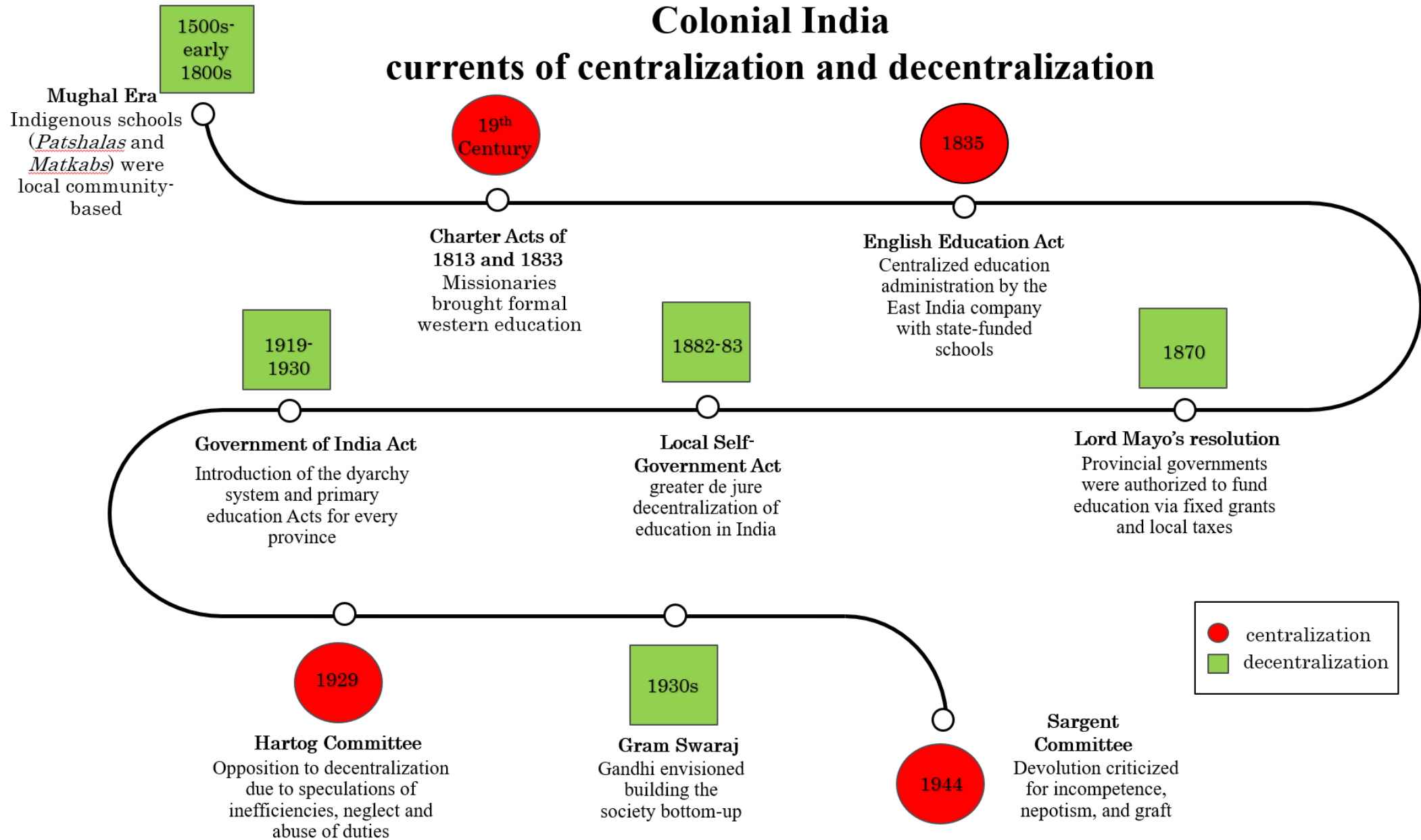
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DOI: 10.1177/08920206241278469

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Colonial India



STATE EDUCATION ACTS

Maharashtra and Gujarat (which were part of Bombay in 1947-1960) followed a different trajectory. The Bombay Primary Education Act- 1947 (later amended and renamed as Maharashtra Primary Education Act) entrusted the District school boards, Municipalities, and Municipal school boards with powers to establish and manage.

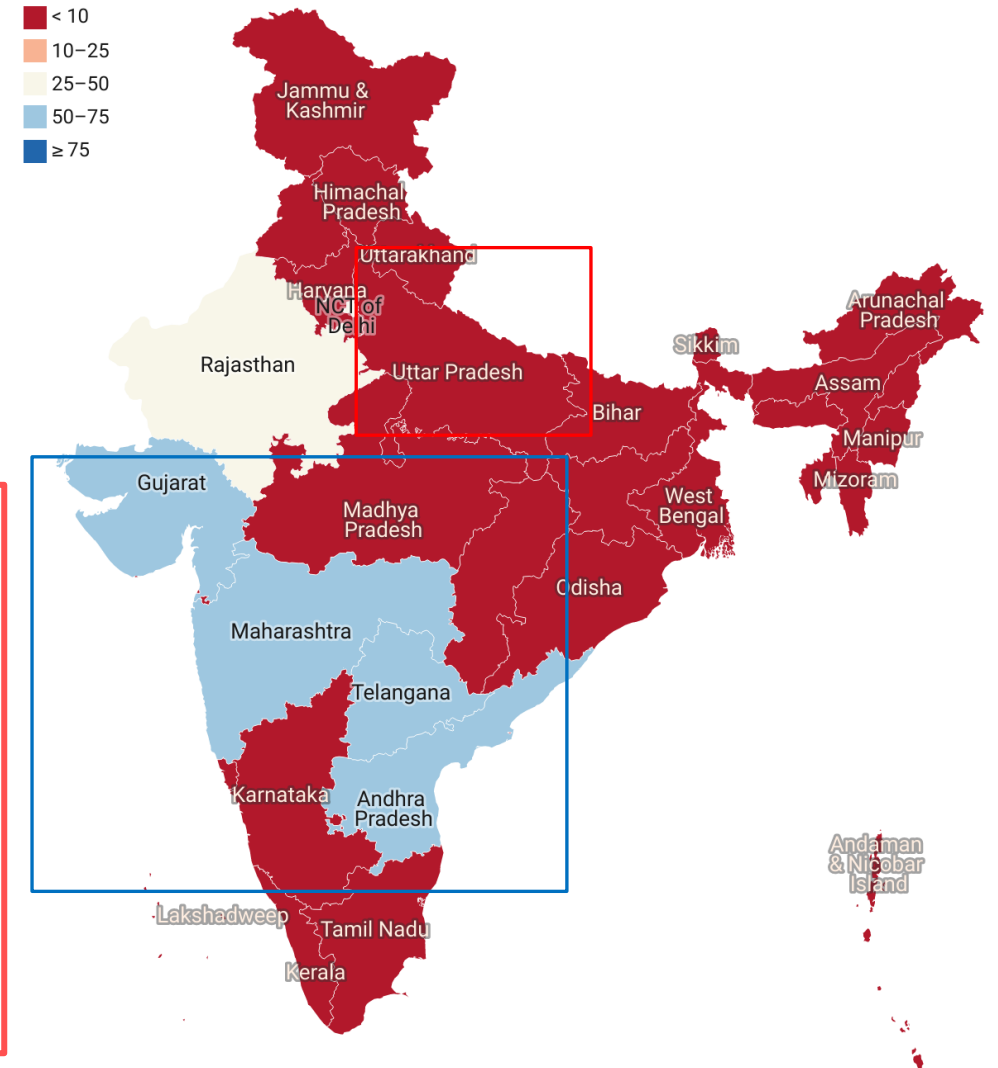
Andhra Pradesh : The Andhra Pradesh Primary Education Act- 1982, vested the power to ensure free and compulsory education to local authorities- (municipal corporation/municipal council, Zilla Praja Parishad, Mandala Praja Parishad).

Karnataka: Karnataka Education Act- 1983 gave sweeping powers to the state to regulate general education including the establishment and recognition of schools, the appointment of teachers in government schools. The state to take over the management, of educational institutions, including local authority schools and private schools, all in “public interest”

Uttar Pradesh: the Basic Education Act of 1972, brought all the local body and/or zilla parishad schools under the state government's direct control, teacher appointment became more centralized, and their salaries were paid by the state government directly

Percentage of Local Body Schools in Indian States

Local body schools (%) - based on UDISE 2021-22



Post-colonial India

currents of centralization and decentralization

Constitution of India

A highly centralised two-tier Federal system was adopted

1950

1951-54

Kher Committee Report

Local administration caused teacher harassment. Safeguards were recommended.

1966

Kothari Commission

Advocated for a greater role of state governments in education governance

1970-1990

State Education Acts

Took control of Education from local bodies. Controls funds and functionaries

1992

NPE & PoA

envisaged district and village-level bodies to plan, implement and administer educational programmes

1992-93

73rd and 74th constitutional amendments

Mandated decentralization- criticized for being unsuccessful as PRIs lacked the resources carry out their duties

1984

Planning Commission
Recommended a multi-level planning framework with districts being treated as sub-states

2001

Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, Central schemes

Funding for Education from Centre- also controls education ; District level Planning Village Edu Committees

2009

RTE Act

Assigns duties to local governments without empowering them. There is limited fiscal transfer

2020

National Education Policy

Silent about PRIs, urban local bodies or educational decentralization

- centralization
- decentralization
- mixed